

**BOTSWANA**

Capital city: Gaborone
Area: 231,803 sq miles (600,370 sq km)
Population: 1,800,000
Official language: English
Major religions: traditional beliefs 50%, Christian 30%, other 20%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Pula
Adult literacy rate: 79%
Life expectancy: 38 years
People per doctor: 3,333
Televisions: 20 per 1,000 people

NAMIBIA

Capital city: Windhoek
Area: 318,694 sq miles (825,418 sq km)
Population: 2,000,000
Official language: English
Major religions: Christian 90%, traditional beliefs 10%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Namibian dollar
Adult literacy rate: 83%
Life expectancy: 42 years
People per doctor: 3,333
Televisions: 37 per 1,000 people

BOTSWANA

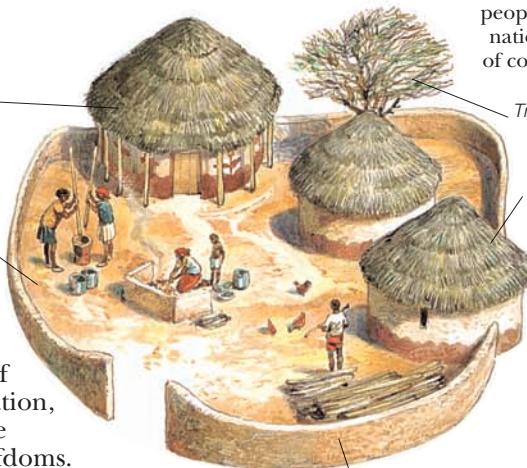
WITH ONE OF THE WORLD'S FASTEST growing economies, based on rich diamond supplies and large cattle ranches, Botswana was one of Africa's few real economic success stories. In recent years, however, it has become the most powerful symbol of Africa's greatest modern threat – HIV and AIDS. It has one of the highest proportions of sufferers in the world – 36 percent of adults are infected.

Parents and young children live in the main sleeping hut.

People cook, eat, and receive guests in the lolwapa.

TSWANA HOMES

The Tswana people, who make up most of the Botswana population, traditionally organize themselves into chiefdoms. Each chiefdom consists of a capital town, around which are a number of satellite villages. Families live in dwellings made up of three or four huts, each hut serving a particular purpose. The huts are arranged around a central courtyard, or *lolwapa*.



The lolwapa is surrounded by a low wall.

Trees are valued for their shade.

Women are responsible for building and maintaining the huts.



The thatched roof is supported on poles that circle the wall of the hut. The space between the wall and the roof gives ventilation.

The huts are decorated with finger markings in earth shades of brown, red, and orange.

To show that she is married, a Himba woman will lengthen her hair by adding hair cut from her brother's head.



NAMIBIA

ORIGINALLY A GERMAN COLONY, Namibia was governed by its neighbor, South Africa, from 1915 until independence in 1990. Rich in minerals and other natural resources, the country is dominated by the Namib Desert, which runs in a thin strip down the west of the country near the Atlantic Ocean, and the vast Kalahari Desert, which lies in the south.

RURAL LIFE

Most Namibian people live on the high plains in the north of the country. Here the Ovambo people build fenced-in enclosures known as *kraals*. The Himba people live farther west in the rugged land bordering Angola. These seminomadic people make their living from tending cattle, which provide them with meat, milk, and clothing. The number of cattle owned is a reflection of wealth and status.

**GABORONE**

When Botswana became independent, the country had no capital city, as it had previously been governed from Mafikeng in South Africa. The new country therefore built a new capital, called Gaborone. Today, more than 200,000 people live in the city, which houses the national government and is the center of communications and industry.

Copper

**MINING**

Namibia is one of the four biggest mineral producers in Africa, with large deposits of copper, diamonds, tin, and other minerals. One of the world's largest uranium mines is located at Rössing, in the Namib Desert, in the center of the country. Namibia is the largest producer of salt in Africa.

Find out more

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